

If you're a total fashion newbie like me, you'll probably find it helpful to look at Pinterest fashion boards and magazine outfits for inspiration. The key is to focus on classic pieces, without going too trendy. You can play with trends in your accessories, which are more easily switched out anyway.

Another idea is to create your own capsule wardrobe, often called the minimalist wardrobe because of its limitations in clothing items and colors. But don't let that description fool you. The capsule wardrobe has a ton of potential.

And if you *really* want to get creative, repurpose clothing items that don't fit or you don't like anymore by using them in a completely different way. An old t-shirt can be turned into a trendy top, and a frayed or holey pair of jeans can easily become shorts or capris. Think about how you can use the piece in a different way before you throw it in the trash!

2. STICK TO THE SALE AND CLEARANCE RACKS

My mother taught me almost everything I know about managing my money, and from an early age, my sister and I always knew the clearance section was the best place to find new clothes. Even now, if I can't find anything I like on the clearance rack, I immediately move on to the next store. Sometimes it's hard to pass up other pieces I love, but I know I would regret paying full price later!

However, the clearance rack isn't the only place to find hidden gems. Knowing seasonal sales and markdown schedules gives you a better chance of scoring the sweater you love at a much lower price. Stores are constantly turning over inventory, but right after Christmas and into the New Year, and then again at the end of June are the best times to snag a steal. That's when the big spring and fall collections come out, and you can get huge discounts on anything summer and winter themed.

But let's say there's a clothing item you *really* want. It might be gone by the time the next inventory shipment comes in, and if you truly love it, you can